

with. If the client demands an exorbitant amount of credit, it's alright to walk away from such a project. Finally, at the end of the month, the bills are going to come calling.

Also talk about the penultimate worst case scenario- what happens if a mid-project payment does not come through on time and the absolute worst case- what happens if the payments stop altogether. In such an unsavoury situation, what is your recourse and what will be your actions? Will the work stop till the previous dues are cleared? Is there a late fee applicable? Or in the worst case scenario will you approach a lawyer?

Another point to include here is what happens if the cheque given by the client bounces. You will incur a cheque return charges- will they be added to the revised invoice? You can also include your bank details and specify a preferred mode of payment.

Revisions

Leave this point and you will open yourself to a lot of possible regret. Just like scope creep, revisions can blow out of proportion and you will end up doing double the work than you had bargained for.

You should always expect a certain number of editing and revision to be done. Make note of the phrase certain number. Specify the number of revisions you are willing to undertake without extra charges. Communicate to the client, in as many words, that post this number, regular charges as defined earlier will be applicable. Also mention when are these revisions are expected and what are the timelines for them.

E.g. as a website designer you might agree to change the colour scheme once, post that any changes will be charged separately. This also puts responsibility on the client to be more attentive and prepared while outlining the requirements.

Termination fee

Unfortunately, sometimes a project can get cancelled. And you are already halfway through the work which can potentially go down the drain. Ouch! Include a termination or kill fee that states the amount you will be paid in such a situation. Again, the calculation methodology can differ for type of work and from project to project. If you are a writer, you can demand the payment for the words written till then or as a designer, a certain percentage of your total expected fee. This clause ensures that you still get compensated for your time and effort even if things go awry for the project.